



Razer pro|tone m250

Slightly overpriced

Razer is all over the gaming market. Mice, mouse pads, keyboards—they have it all covered. They've now diverted some of their focus towards regular consumers, and the latest

themselves are sturdy, but the cables are pretty thin and can be easily damaged. The cable is short as well, which may be good for your portable MP3 player, but not so good if you plan on using it at home on your PC. The

clips for the headphones



are the Razer pro|tone m250 portable clip-on headphones.

Like all Razer products, the m250s look great. The backs have a brushed metal finish. The headphones

have a layer of rubber, which makes them comfortable for long sessions even if they're clipped on tight.

Coming to quality and performance, the m250s

are really loud. The treble is overpowering, while the bass is very low and sounds flat. Frequencies between 2.5 and 10 kHz are the most prominent. There was no distortion at the insanely high volumes it reached, though. The disappointing bass response is mainly because of the frequency range—which starts from 50 Hz, instead of around 20 Hz like with most headphones. There is no noise isolation.

The Razer pro|tone m250 costs Rs 3,399, which is very expensive, but then you need to keep the performance in

mind too. The device would be used for mobile entertainment, and there happen to be quite a few cheaper alternatives that offer better audio quality. Some canal earplugs cost around half what the m250 costs give better bass, and offer noise isolation! If you're a Razer fan, you could make this part of your collection; if you're not, look elsewhere.

Specifications

Weight: 38 gm; frequency response: 50 Hz ~ 20,000 Hz; connector: 3.5 mm; cable length: 1.15 m, Maximum Sound Press Level: 105 dB; impedance: 32 ohms

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Contact: Net Place Technologies P Ltd

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Web site: www.razerpro.com

Price: Rs 3,399

Sony NW-A805

Performs well; slightly expensive

The Sony NW-A805 player's format and style resembles that of many compact phones, only this one comes with three big buttons. There are four other direct buttons to navigate through the interface displayed on the crisp 2-inch colour LCD screen.

The player has 2 GB of internal memory, and no expansion slots. You can play audio and video, and view images on it. Certain audio enhancement features—DSEE (Digital Sound Enhancement Engine) and VPT (Virtualphones Technology)—are built into the player. DSEE is supposed to enhance quality, and VPT

means you get virtual surround sound. A feature called Dynamic Normalization helps balance out major volume jumps between tracks.

The player comes with canal earphones, which isolate noise pretty effectively. Speaking of earphones, the cord is really short; thankfully, an extension cable is provided. We also used the Bose 321 Series in-ear phones as a standard to gauge quality. Bass was decent, and so was the treble. Using the Bose earphones over the Sony ones gave us just a tiny improvement in quality—meaning the Sony earphones themselves are pretty decent, and you won't have to go hunting for separate ones.

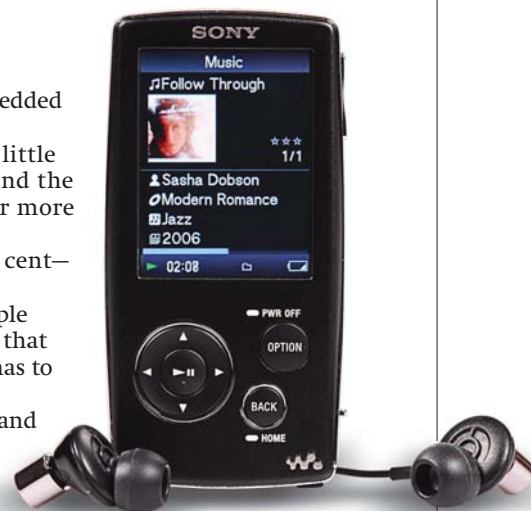
You can use the player as a storage device. The transfer rates were around 1.29 MB/s while transferring files

directly onto the embedded memory.

Charging takes a little under three hours, and the charge easily lasts for more than a day with the volume set to 50 per cent—really good.

Similar to the Apple players, all the media that goes onto the player has to pass through Sony's software—SonicStage and Image Converter. The media is converted to the supported formats. The software lacks an attractive interface, but gets the job done. You get two extra pairs of caps for the earplugs, and a stand to place the player on.

Rs 9,990 is not exactly cheap for a 2 GB player. You do get a video player and an image viewer, but neither of which are very exciting on the tiny 2-inch screen. It's not extremely compact either. For the same price, you'd be better off getting a



media player with a larger storage capacity.

Specifications

Dimensions: 43.8 (W) x 88 (H) x 9.1 (D) mm; weight: 53 gm; inbuilt memory: 2 GB

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Web site: www.sony.co.in

Price: Rs 9,990

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆